

Lecture 09 (2026-07-12)

Quick Summary

- **Evaluation of Persuasion:** Distinction between **Automatic processing** (fast, emotional, easily swayed by aesthetics) and **Controlled processing** (slow, logic-based, harder to sway).
- **Cultural Context in Communication:** Understanding the difference between **High Context** (nuanced, relies on context) and **Low Context** (direct, explicit) communication styles.
- **Information Security:** The necessity of restricting information access and monitoring communication channels, especially in high-risk sectors like banking and audit.
- **Channel Selection Logic:** Choosing communication media based on "Richness" (the ability to convey nuance and receive immediate feedback) and the specific goal (e.g., routine updates vs. gaining acceptance).
- **Cross-Cultural Nuances:** Managing global teams by accounting for "Acculturation" and varying cultural norms regarding personal space and directness.

Key Definitions

- **Work Group:** A collection of individuals whose skill sets are random/varied; they lack a common objective or synergy, and accountability is primarily individual.
- **Work Team:** A group with a common understanding, common objectives, and synergy. They await complementary skills, and accountability is both individual and mutual.
- **Cross-functional Team:** A team composed of members from different functional areas. These are typically time-bound and are common in project management, product launches, or job rotations.
- **Virtual Team:** Teams that are linked by technology rather than geographic proximity (e.g., a distributed faculty team).
- **Self-managed Team:** Teams with a high degree of autonomy, often used in roles with interdependencies or by independent contractors/freelancers.
- **Problem-solving Team:** Teams and individuals brought together to solve a specific problem or perform a specific task (e.g., a multi-departmental medical review).
- **Effectiveness:** Whether a team can get the job done; it relates to the **intent**, purpose, and the fulfillment of the basic objective for which the team was formed.
- **Efficiency:** How made resources (time, money, etc.) are used to get the job done; it relates to the **method** and speed.
- **Psychological Safety:** A culture of trust that allows for "participation" rather than "judgment," reducing the fear of being "punished" for speaking up.
- **Creator:** A role focused on the creation of ideas and initiating creative content.
- **Linker:** A role focused on coordination and integration; requires a high need for socialization and an extroverted personality.
- **Promoter:** A role focused on execution, revision, and implementing ideas.
- **Assessor:** A role providing insight, analysis, and critical evaluation of options.
- **Organizer:** A role focused on structure, documentation, and resource management.
- **Producer:** A role focused on providing direction and follow-through.
- **Controller:** A role focused on auditing, ensuring compliance with rules/timelines, and corrective actions.
- **Advisor:** A role focused on seeking information and understanding external industry context.
- **Process Gains:** Positive impacts on team performance resulting from group processes (e.g., shared mental models).

- **Process Losses:** Negative plans on team performance resulting from group processes (e.g., "chatter" or "talking nonsense" which wastes time).
- **Management:** Communication used to manage member behavior via authority, policies, and job descriptions.
- **Feedback:** Communication used to clarify what employees must do, how well they are doing, and how they can improve.
- **Emotional Sharing:** Communication that allows members to express feelings and satisfy social needs.
- **Persuasion:** Communication to influence others (can be positive, e.g., CSR, or negative, e.g., breaking rules).
- **Information Exchange:** Communication to provide the data needed to identify and evaluate choices for decision-making.
- **Grapevine:** Informal communication with no known source; helps managers gauge morale and identify employee anxieties.
- **Down-ward Communication:** Flow from a higher to a lower level; includes assigning goals, instructions, policy/procedures, and explaining "why" a decision was made.
- **Up-ward Communication:** Flow to a higher level; used for feedback, progress reports, and highlighting issues.
- **Lateral Communication:** Communication between peers at the same level; used for speed and coordination, but can cause dysfunctional conflict.
- **Chain Network:** A linear communication line; accuracy is moderate.
- **Wheel Network:** A central person acts as the hub; results in high leader emergence.
- **All-Channel Network:** Every member is connected to every other member; offers the highest speed and satisfaction.
- **Oral Communication:** Primary means of conveying messages; includes speeches, formal one-on-one/group discussions, and informal grapevine.
- **Automatic Processing:** A relatively superficial consideration of evidence and information; fast, low effort, but easily influenced by aesthetics (jingles, photos).
- **Controlled Processing:** A detailed consideration of evidence and information relying on facts, figures, and logic; requires more effort but is harder to mislead.
- **High Context:** Communication where the meaning is tied to the context/relationships; not everything is explicitly stated.
- **Low Context:** Communication where everything is explicitly stated; no hidden meanings or nuanced interpretation is required.
- **Acculturation:** The process by which individuals in different countries adopt local cultural norms and behaviors.
- **Information Security:** The protection of electronic and physical data; crucial in banking/audit/consulting to prevent leaks of sensitive data (e.g., account numbers).
- **Physical Distance:** A non-verbal cue where "businesslike distance" in one culture (e.g., European) may be perceived as "intimate" in another (e.g., North American).

Worked Examples

Exhibit 10-2: Four Types of Teams (from [shot_00-17-12.png]) * Problem-solving * Self-managed * Cross-functional * Virtual * **Note: This categorization is used to determine the best structure based on specific job requirements and the necessity of synergy.**

Impact of a "wrong" employee on team performance ([shot_00-31-50.png]) * "Keeping one wrong person on your team is like having a virus that slowly kills the entire organization." * **Calculation/Impact:** A single disengaged employee can reduce team performance by up to **54%**. * **Reasoning:** This is not just a measurement of one person's output; it represents how one person's lack of commitment drags down the collective success of the entire team.

Capability vs. Commitment Matrix ([shot_00-31-50.png], [shot_00-32-40.png]) * **Y-axis: Capability** * Skills * Knowledge * Experience * The ability to deliver results * **X-axis: Commitment** * Motivation * Engagement * Cultural Fit * Willingness to go the extra mile * **Note:** Capability alone is insufficient; high performance requires the intersection of both capability and commitment.

Team Effectiveness Model ([shot_00-42-58.png], [shot_00-44-09.png]) The model identifies three pillars of team effectiveness: * **Context:** Adequate resources, Leadership and structure, Climate of trust, and Performance evaluation and reward systems. * **Composition:** Abilities of members, Personalities, Allocating roles, Diversity, Member differences, Size of teams, and Member preferences. * **Process:** Common purpose, Shared goals, Team efficacy, Team synergy, Team cohesion, Mental models, Conflict levels.

Formula for Team Performance ([shot_00-52-28.png]) * **Calculation:** Potential group effectiveness + Process gains - Process losses = Actual group effectiveness. * **Components:** * Potential group effectiveness = knowledge + abilities + skills. * **Note:** Process losses include items like "chatter" (waste of time).

Strategy for Creating Team Players ([shot_00-54-23.png]) * **Selection:** Hire team players. * **Training:** Create team players (equip with tools/skills). * **Rewarding:** Incentives to be a good team player (rewarding cooperative efforts).

Management Implications for Team Building ([shot_00-58-40.png]) * **Infrastructure:** Adequate resources, effective leadership, climate of trust, and reward systems reflecting team contributions. * **Personnel:** Individuals with technical expertise and the right traits/skills. * **Scale:** Effective teams tend to be smaller. * **Motivation:** Members who fulfill role demands and prefer being part of a group.

Communication Functions ([shot_01-14-05.png], [shot_01-19-11.png], [shot_01-20-38.png], [shot_01-21-59.png], [shot_01-23-39.png], [shot_01-26-12.png], [shot_01-27-32.png]) * **Management:** Directing behavior through authority, policy, and job descriptions. * **Feedback:** Identifying what to do, how well they are doing, and how they can improve (essential for motivation). * **Emotional Sharing:** Allowing members to share feelings and fulfill social needs. * **Persuasion:** Influencing behavior (Positive: CSR; Negative: urging others to break rules). * **Information Exchange:** Providing data to facilitate decision-making.

Communication Process Diagram ([shot_01-28-49.png]) * **Sender:** (1) Message to be sent $\rightarrow$ (2) Encoding message. * **Channel:** The medium (affected by "Noise"). * **Receiver:** (1) Message received $\rightarrow$ (2) Decoding message. * **Feedback:** A loop returning from the receiver to the sender to ensure understanding.

Scenario: The "Sunday Meeting" Challenge * **Context:** A manager must call a meeting on a Sunday due to a peak demand (e.g., year-end closing). * **Strategy:** 1. **Transparency:** Be upfront about the specific need/demand. 2. **Reciprocity:** Offer a "concession" (e.g., an extra day off next month) to balance the sacrifice. * **Reasoning:** This creates a "win-win" where the manager addresses the business need while the employee feels valued and compensated.

Scenario: Investigating Performance Drops * **Case Study:** A team member appears to be underperforming. * **Investigation:** Use communication to determine if the cause is **capability** (lack of skill) or **resources** (e.g., the employee didn't have access to the machine). * **Result:** Prevents the manager from unfairly judging the individual's competence when the issue is actually a structural/resource gap.

Allocation of Time at Work for Managers and Professionals ([shot_01-44-07.png]) * **Reading and answering e-mail:** 28% * **Searching and gathering information:** 19% * **Communicating and collaborating internally:** 14% * **Role-specific tasks:** 39%

Suitability of Communication Channels (Reference: [shot_01-51-29.png]) * **Rule for Routine Messages:** If the message is routine (clear, low ambiguity), use **Written Communication**. * **Rule for**

Engagement/Receptivity: Use **Oral Communication** (meetings, phone, etc.) when you need to gauge the receiver's receptivity, seek engagement, or convince them to "buy" an idea. * **Rule for Complexity:** Use **Written Communication** for complex or lengthy communication as it is more reliable for documentation.

Contractual Communication Standards * Standard professional forms: **Offer Letter, Appointment Letter, and Relieving Letter.**

Persuasive Communication Processing ([shot_01-54-16.png], [shot_01-55-31.png]) * **Automatic Processing:** Use when you need to appeal to emotions or use high-impact visuals (jingles/photos). * **Controlled Processing:** Use when providing facts, figures, and logic to a target audience that is actively evaluating information. * **Rule for Matching:** Match the message to the audience based on: **Interest level, Prior knowledge, Personality, and Message characteristics.**

Formulas & Rules

Rules for Converting Work Groups to Work Teams: To transition from a collection of people (Group) to a functional unit (Team), the following steps must be taken: 1. **Intentional Selection:** Choose members based on Job Descriptions (JD), specific skill sets (e.g., technical, sales, coordination), and personality types (e.g., MBTI). 2. **Skill Complementarity:** Ensure skills are not just "different" but "complementary" to create synergy. 3. **Goal Alignment:** Align the individual goals of team members with the collective goals of the organization/team. 4. **Information Sharing:** Ensure constant communication to establish rapport and mutual understanding.

Rule for Team Assessment: * **Effectiveness Rule:** Focus on "What" (purpose, goal attainment). * **Efficiency Rule:** Focus on "How" (resource management, speed). * **Exam Note:** In this context, team evaluation focuses primarily on **Effectiveness.**

Selection Sequence: To build an effective team, follow the sequence of **Skill $\rightarrow$ Personality $\rightarrow$ Role Assignment**. 1. Identify the skill set (Capability). 2. Determine personality type. 3. Assign specific roles (e.g., "Single point of contact" or "Coordinator") based on the intersection of skill and suitability.

Rule for Role Assignment Matching: * Match the role to the personality trait. * **Linker Role:** Must be assigned to an extrovert/someone with high social needs. * **Risk:** Assigning a Linker role to an introvert leads to hesitation and poor team coordination.

Rule for Individual vs. Team Decision: * **Use Individual when:** * Tasks need to be done very quickly. * Crisis management or urgent situations occur. * Work is confidential. * The task does not benefit from interdependency. * **Use Teams when:** * Creative tasks are required. * The work requires multi-faceted collaboration/consensus.

Rule for Communication Channels: * **Oral/Face-to-Face:** Preferred for "connection," "persuasion," and "emotional sharing." * **Email:** Use as the **last mode** to make things "official" or "authoritative" (useful for clear instructions/documentation). * **Multi-media (Teams/Zoom):** Effective for larger groups but requires "video on" to capture facial expressions (crucial for non-verbal communication).

Rule for Upward Communication: * **Constraint:** "Keep it brief." * **Format:** Use **headlines**, not paragraphs. * **Content:** Support headlines with **actionable items** and always provide an **agenda** to respect the superior's time.

Rule for Graveyard/Grapevine Management: * **Action:** Do not ignore it; use it to gauge morale and identify concerns. * **Response Strategy:** Respond to rumors **non-committally** and then **verify** the facts internally.

Rule for Information Security: * **Critical Sectors:** Audit, taxation, and banking require strict adherence to protocols. * **Control:** Limit access to sensitive information (e.g., bank account data) to only essential personnel; avoid using personal accounts for official business.

Rule for Cross-Cultural Strategy: * **Identify Context:** Determine if the culture is High Context (requires reading between lines) or Low Context (needs explicit clarity). * **Adapt Style:** Adjust for cultural distance and "Acculturation" levels; avoid overly direct "face" confrontation in cultures that value indirectness.

Tricky Logic & Traps

- **Data vs. Sentiment on WFH:** Be careful if a question asks about productivity vs. cultural benefit. While "community" and "mentorship" are gained in the office, **actual data** indicates productivity is slightly higher in WFH environments.
- **The "Time-Bound" Indicator:** When a question mentions a "project," "product launch," or "specific duration," the correct team type is almost always **Cross-functional**.
- **The "New Hire" Gap:** A common risk in remote/virtual hiring is that new employees lose out on "physical" negotiation and navigation skills.
Group vs. Team Differentiation:
 - If the prompt mentions "random/varid" skills or "no common objective" $\rightarrow$ **Work Group**.
 - If the prompt mentions "complementary" skills, "synergy," or "mutual accountability" $\rightarrow$ **Work Team**.
- **Synergy vs. Choice:** In a **Work Team**, members are not "competing" but "complementing" each other. If a scenario describes members trying to figure out "who does what," it is not yet an effective team.
- **The "Viral" Impact Trap:** A "wrong" employee is not just an underperformer; they are a "virus." If a prompt mentions a team's performance dropping significantly due to a single disengaged member, use the **54%** metric.
- **Efficiency vs. Effectiveness Trap:** These are not synonyms. If the scenario focuses on "meeting the goal/purpose," the answer is **Effectiveness**. If it focuses on "minimizing resources/time," it is **Efficiency**.
- **Leadership vs. Management Role Trap:** If a member raises a concern regarding "rules" or "governance" and the leader says "that is your role to handle," it indicates a failure in the **Leadership/Structure** component of the "Context" pillar.
- **The "Talent vs. Attitude" Trap:** A "talented" individual with a poor attitude/lack of team commitment may be skilled for themselves but fails the team. Selection must prioritize the **intersection** of skill and attitude.
- **Role Misalignment Trap:** Assigning a **Linker** role to a person who is an introvert or is "hesitant" to talk to others results in a mismatch; the role must align with the personality's social requirements.
- **The "Always a Team" Assumption:** Teams are not always the solution. If a scenario involves **crisis, urgency, or confidentiality**, the optimal path is often an **individual** action.
- **Grapevine Logic:** Do not ignore the grapevine; it is a tool to understand what employees consider important and their anxieties. If there is a rumor, respond **non-committally** and verify the truth.
- **Email vs. Face-to-Face:** Face-to-face is the "gold standard" for persuasion and connection. Email should be reserved for **formal/official** documentation or instructions where ambiguity must be avoided.
- **Video Etiquette:** Using "video on" during a call with a senior is a matter of **protocol**. Turning it off can be seen as disrespectful or a lack of engagement.
- **The "Why" of Decisions:** When making non-standard requests (e.g., weekend work), the manager must communicate the **reason** for the request to ensure buy-in and "acceptability."
- **The "Noodle Bowl" Rumor Trap:** When a rumor regarding a team member's departure circulates through "someone to someone," do not leap to immediate confrontation. Use it as a signal to perform an **indirect check** to see if there is a fixable issue.

- **The "Offer" Trap:** Be aware of specific formal documents: **Offer Letter**, **Appointment Letter**, and **Relieving Letter**. These are not negotiations but standard contractual items.
- **The "Persuasion" Method Trap:** Do not use a complex "Controlled" method for a casual "Automatic" scenario. Match the persuasion method to the audience's **Interest, Knowledge, and Personality**.
- **The "Cross-Cultural Barrier" Trap:** Be aware that even in English-speaking environments, "Acculturation" and "Context" (High vs. Low) change how you must present an argument. A "direct" approach that works in the US may be inappropriate in Middle Eastern contexts.

Exam Pointers

Identifying the Team Type: In the open-hammer exam, look for specific keywords in the prompt to select the correct team type:

- "Multi-departmental" or "r&d" $\rightarrow$ **Problem-solving**.
- "Time-bound" or "Product Launch" $\rightarrow$ **Cross-functional**.
- "Remote," "different locations," or "Technology-linked" $\rightarrow$ **Virtual**.
- "Freelance," "interdependencies," or "High autonomy" $\rightarrow$ **Self-managed**.
- **Selection Strategy:** If asked how to form a team, the answer should involve a multi-step process: identifying the JD, assessing personality types (MBTI), and ensuring skill complementarity rather than just diversity.
- **Contract/Reward Link:** When questions mention "performance evaluation" or "reward systems," link these to the **Expectancy Model** (ensuring the employee knows their effort/performance is tied to their rewards/promotion).
- **Identifying Intent:** In scenarios where the goal is "reaching the shore" or fulfilling a "purpose," the focus is on **Effectiveness**.
- **Distinguishing Process Gains/Losses:** If a scenario mentions "time wasted on chatter" or "social loafing," identify this as a **Process Loss**.

Communication Mechanics:

- If the question asks about **how to communicate a new policy**: Use **Downward Communication**.
- If the question asks about **reporting progress to a boss**: Use **Upward Communication** (Headlines, Actionable items, Agenda).
- If the question asks about **coordinating with a peer**: Use **Lateral Communication**.
- If the question asks about **how to handle rumors**: Use the **Grapevine** strategy (non-committal response + verification).

Network Structures:

- If a scenario needs **High Leadership Emergence** $\rightarrow$ **Wheel**.
- If a scenario needs **High Speed/Satisfaction** $\rightarrow$ **All-Channel**.
- If the question involves a linear chain with **Moderate Accuracy** $\rightarrow$ **Chain**.

Selecting Communication Channels:

- Use **Oral** for: Gauging receptivity, engagement, acceptance, and persuasive "buy-in."
- Use **Written** for: Routine tasks (low ambiguity), long/complex documents, and formal contracts (Offer, Appointment, Relieving).
- **Counseling for Cross-Cultural Barriers:** Look for specific identifiers like "Arabic," "Gulf," or "High Context" to determine if the communication should be more indirect or if different cultural norms for "distance" apply.
- **Information Security Check:** If the prompt involves **Audit**, **Banking**, or **Consulting**, the answer must include strict controls on information access and the avoidance of personal accounts for work.

Sources

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- MPO Session 9-13 2026.pdf

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